



Food & Dining

The 8 Great Cuisines of China: A Complete Guide

CDISCOVERY

<https://cdiscovery-community.netlify.app/>



The 8 Great Cuisines of China: A Complete Guide

Chinese cuisine is not monolithic -- it encompasses 8 major regional traditions, each with distinct flavors, techniques, and ingredients.

1. Cantonese (粤菜) -- Guangdong

Known for: Fresh ingredients, dim sum, subtle flavors. Signature dishes: Char siu (BBQ pork), har gow (shrimp dumplings), siu mai, roast goose. Best in: Guangzhou, Hong Kong.

2. Sichuan (川菜) -- Sichuan

Known for: Mala (numbing-spicy) flavor from Sichuan peppercorns. Signature dishes: Mapo tofu, kung pao chicken, hot pot, dan dan noodles. Best in: Chengdu.

3. Shandong (鲁菜) -- Shandong

Known for: Seafood, braised dishes, clear broths. Signature dishes: Sweet and sour carp, braised sea cucumber, dezhou braised chicken. Best in: Jinan, Qingdao.

4. Jiangsu (苏菜) -- Jiangsu

Known for: Delicate presentation, slightly sweet flavors. Signature dishes:

Squirrel-shaped mandarin fish, lion's head meatballs, Nanjing salted duck. Best in: Nanjing, Suzhou.

5. Zhejiang (浙菜) -- Zhejiang

Known for: Fresh, mellow flavors, seafood. Signature dishes: Dongpo pork, West Lake vinegar fish, Longjing shrimp. Best in: Hangzhou.

6. Fujian (闽菜) -- Fujian



Known for: Umami-rich broths, seafood soups. Signature dishes: Buddha jumps over the wall, oyster omelette, lychee pork. Best in: Fuzhou, Xiamen.

7. Hunan (湘菜) -- Hunan

Known for: Pure hot spiciness (without numbing), smoked meats. Signature dishes: Chairman Mao's red-braised pork, steamed fish head with chili, stir-fried smoked pork.

Best in: Changsha.

8. Anhui (徽菜) -- Anhui

Known for: Wild herbs, braised dishes, mountain ingredients. Signature dishes: Li Hongzhang hodgepodge, hairy tofu, bamboo shoots with cured meat. Best in: Huangshan.

Sources: Sources: [Ministry of Commerce](http://www.mofcom.gov.cn) • [China Daily Food & Culture](http://www.chinadaily.com.cn)

CDISCOVERY

Community Topics Guide

<https://cdiscovery-community.netlify.app/>

Generated on June 8, 2026

Thank you for being part of the CDISCOVERY community